the loss of thousands of lives. In June 1917, the report of the Mesopotamia Commission gave a powerful indictment of the entire campaign and caused the subsequent resignation of the then secretary of state for India, Austen Chamberlain. For more information see Goold, 'Lord Hardinge and the Mesopotamia Expedition and Inquiry, 1914–1917', The Historical Journal , Vol. 19, No. 4 (1976), pp. 919–45.

97. TNA/FO371/3860/77565, Interdepartmental Conference On Middle Eastern Affairs, 7 May 1919.

98. TNA/FO371/3860/68201, Shuckburgh to Foreign Office, 3 May 1919.

99. TNA/CAB27/24, Minutes of Eastern Committee Meeting, 30 Dec. 1918.

100. Curzon to his wife, 17 August 1919. See Ronaldshay, op. cit., p. 217.

101. TNA/FO371/3862/113492, Agreement between the Governments of Great Britain and Persia, 8 Aug. 1919.

102. TNA/FO371/3862/114911, Memorandum by Curzon, 12 Aug. 1919.

103. The Times , 16 Aug. 1919.

104. Daily Telegraph , 16 Aug. 1919.

105. Manchester Guardian , 16 Aug. 1919.

106. Stanwood, War , pp. 74–5.

107. TNA/FO371/3863/122515, Cox to Foreign Office, 29 Aug. 1919.

108. TNA/FO371/3862/118250, Curzon to Lindsay, 18 Aug. 1919; TNA/FO371/3863/127878 Cox to Foreign Office relaying American communiqué, 10 Sept. 1919; TNA/FO371/3863/128532, Curzon to Mr Davis, 13 Sept. 1919. For more on American and French reaction to the agreement, see Fatemi, History of Persia , pp. 54–72.

109. TNA/FO371/3863/123784, Cox to Foreign Office, 1 Sept. 1919.